

Puzzle #3 -- SMOOTH Clues

Malaika Handa / Edited by Brad Wilber

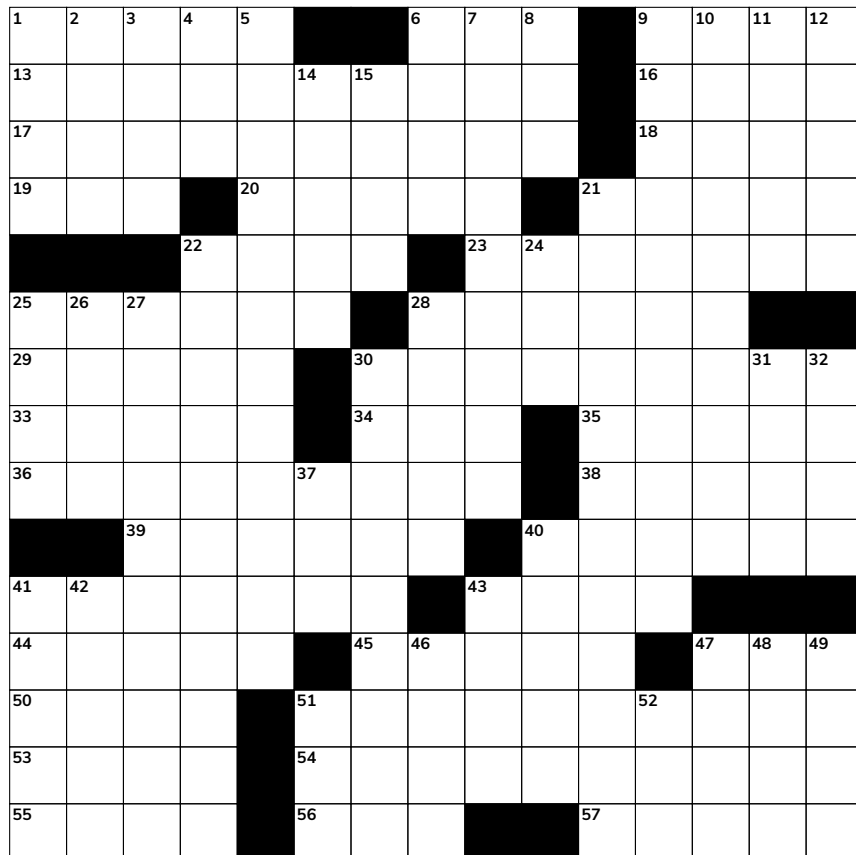
ACROSS

- 1 Flashes of inspiration
- 6 Rank higher than cpl.
- 9 Apt rhyme for "slam"
- 13 Sheet for geometry homework
- 16 It's the pits!
- 17 Striped storefront display descended from the caduceus
- 18 "Respect" songwriter Redding
- 19 Bird perched on Athena's hand, in iconography
- 20 Worshiper in dreadlocks, informally
- 21 "___ luck!"
- 22 Lighten, as a headache or a stain
- 23 Drink holders at parties?
- 25 Pretty, in Spanish
- 28 Noncompetitive amount on eBay
- 29 River dividing into "le Grand" and "le Petit" at Arles, France
- 30 Recovered from a kegger, say
- 33 "¿Dónde ___?" ("Where are you?")
- 34 Org. that charges \$2.75 per ride
- 35 Make ___ (rake in profits)

- 36 Jetsetting series of concerts
- 38 Plans to eat?
- 39 Kindle readings
- 40 Attacks
- 41 Spritzed scent
- 43 Facilities at Buckingham Palace
- 44 Stock up on
- 45 Inundate
- 47 Texas sch. that separated itself from church control in 2019
- 50 Aids in cleaning aquariums
- 51 Animal used to forage for fungi
- 53 James who was Time magazine's film critic in the 1940s
- 54 Orientation "halfway" between allo and ace
- 55 Little blokes
- 56 Back-to-school mo., for many
- 57 Boxer Charles Liston, more familiarly

DOWN

- 1 Nigerian ethnic group
- 2 Nil-nil, e.g.
- 3 Rank higher than a viscount
- 4 Alert like a BOLO
- 5 Twitter account where Michaela Okland scores screenshots of cringey male behavior on social media



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- 6 Dalmatian marking
- 7 Place with cool treats?
- 8 Three, on Capri
- 9 Soft chocolate-and-cream sandwiches
- 10 Warming cocktails of whiskey, lemon and honey
- 11 Premiere invitees
- 12 Flat-topped hills
- 14 "The Devil Wears ___"
- 15 Church section with a semi-dome
- 21 Curly-coated crossbreeds
- 22 Villains at the ends of video games
- 24 Barnyard mother
- 25 Witchy concoction
- 26 "I feel pretty, ___ pretty ..." (lyric sung by Maria)
- 27 Like Michael Jordan and Michael B. Jordan
- 28 India's national flower
- 30 Like all hotel rooms in Colorado, by law
- 31 Beauty chain that stocks ColourPop
- 32 Little sibling, often
- 37 Pachyderm unit
- 40 Moments on blooper reels
- 41 Staple of Venice vacation photos
- 42 Letter used in STEM's "Big O" notation
- 43 Featuring the imperfections of home recording, informally
- 46 Element of properly-mixed pancake batter
- 47 Ostracize
- 48 Complain
- 49 Descriptor for a certain duckling
- 51 6-pt. plays in football
- 52 Prefix with skeleton

Puzzle #3 -- CHOPPY Clues

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ACROSS

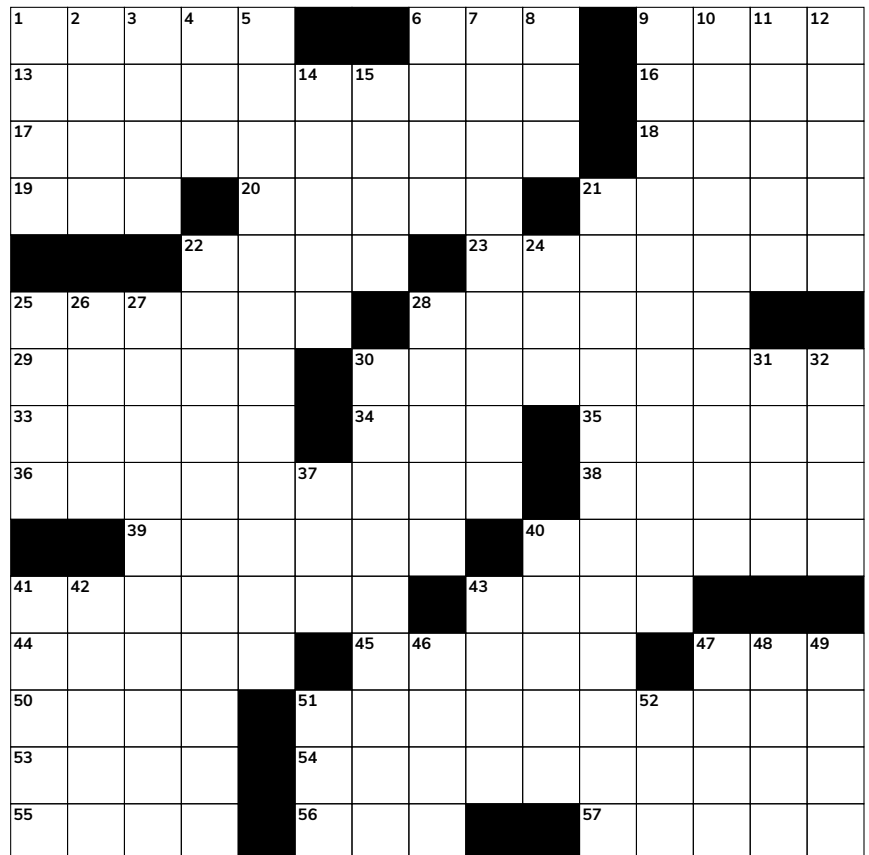
- 1 Brainstorming results
- 6 Snorkel in "Beetle Bailey," e.g.: Abbr.
- 9 Onomatopoeic band name of the 1980s
- 13 Boxes eventually filled with blueprints?
- 16 Word with doughnut or ozone
- 17 Red-white-and-blue storefront posting
- 18 Trademark holder for "escalator"
- 19 DuoLingo mascot
- 20 ___ pasta (Jamaican dish)
- 21 Oodles of
- 22 A "hi-top" one used to be called a "cameo cut"
- 23 Clay collectibles from Yixing
- 25 "Ay, qué ___!" (compliment from Abuela)
- 28 Offer from an ambivalent buyer
- 29 Relevant river never mentioned in the folk song "Sur le Pont d'Avignon"

- 38 South Beach and Mediterranean, e.g.
- 39 Items checked out using the Libby app
- 40 Undertakes with gusto
- 41 Lufthansa headquarters city
- 43 Lavs at Heathrow
- 44 Collect
- 45 What may break the bank?
- 47 Where to see Mustangs in Dallas, for short
- 50 Clears after taxes
- 51 Livestock rooting for its owner?
- 53 Pulitzer winner with a namesake street in Knoxville, Tennessee
- 54 Orientation in which attraction occurs after emotional bonds are formed
- 55 Restroom door sign at some pubs
- 56 B'day month for some Libras
- 57 Bono in Congress

DOWN

- 30 Regained clarity after revelry
- 33 "___ Ahi, Dios? Soy Yo, Margaret" (Judy Blume title in Spanish)
- 34 Agcy. managing an A, B, C, D, and F
- 35 "Good imagination and ___ of junk" (Edison's necessities for invention)
- 36 It takes a traveling show far and wide

- 1 People in Chinua Achebe's "Things Fall Apart"
- 2 Produce sketches
- 3 "Goodbye, ___" (song by The Chicks)
- 4 BOLO equivalent
- 5 Twitter account where Michaela Okland scores screenshots of cringey male behavior on social media



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- 6 Not allow a barbell to fall, say
- 7 Type of American creamery with an Italian focus
- 8 Square root of nove
- 9 Round, layered treats sometimes served in a gingerbread variation
- 10 Après-ski rounds
- 11 "The ___" (young-adult novel set in Beverly Hills)
- 12 Some Southwestern scenery
- 14 Luxury fashion brand that owns Miu Miu
- 15 "Pain in the ___" (cheekily-titled theology blog)
- 21 Domestic animals that can be fleece-coated
- 22 Antagonists that rear up right before gamers can claim victory
- 24 Domestic animal that can be fleece-coated
- 25 Beginning to ski?
- 26 Incredibly
- 27 Like Kristen Stewart and Martha Stewart
- 28 Floral symbol of longevity, in China
- 30 Like an environment with no butts about it?
- 31 Beauty chain that took the 15 Percent Pledge
- 32 Certain home invader
- 37 Word on bridge signs
- 40 Class clowns
- 41 The Ever Given was stuck in one in 2021
- 42 Beleaguered member of a wolf pack hierarchy
- 43 Like most DIY audio recordings
- 46 Unit of sugar
- 47 "___ the nonbeliever!" (cry from YouTube's Charlie the Unicorn)
- 48 Haunted house sound
- 49 Far from civil
- 51 Gridiron OT enders
- 52 Outer part?

Puzzle #3 -- STORMY Clues

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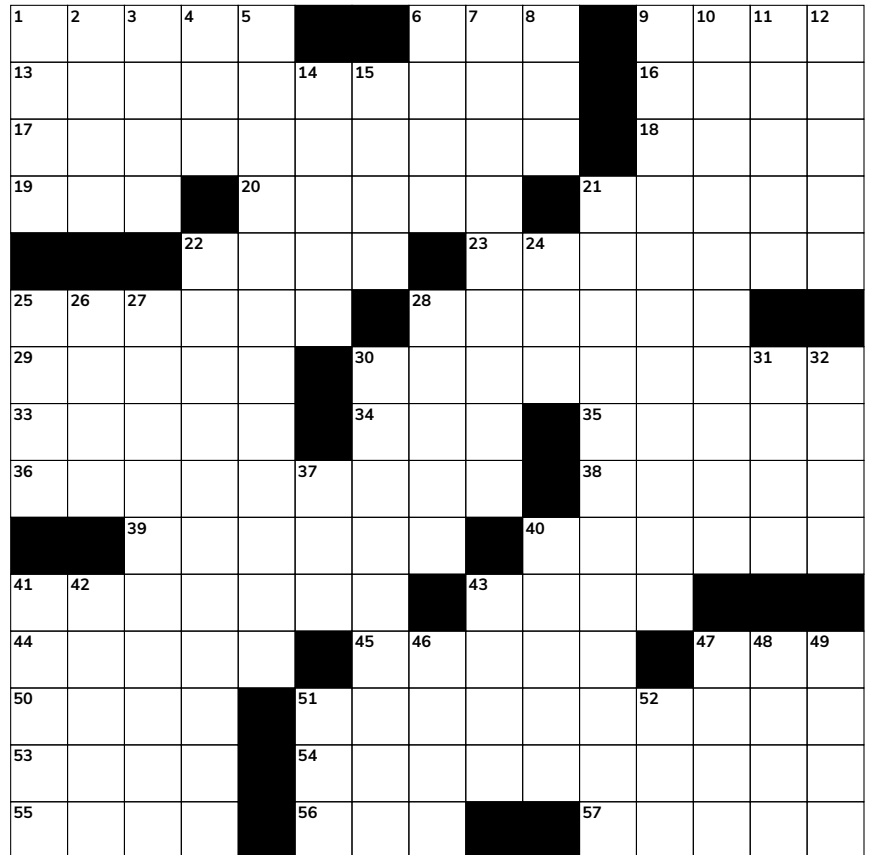
ACROSS

- 1 Flashes
- 6 Abbr. on a populous Fab Four album cover
- 9 Sound punctuating some indignant exits
- 13 Where squares congregate in math class?
- 16 Green focal point
- 17 Iconic trade sign with a helix
- 18 Car company?
- 19 Pooh friend who misspells his own name
- 20 Believer observing Grounation Day
- 21 Many, casually
- 22 Drake's style
- 23 What Brits gesture to with the offer "Shall I be Mother?"
- 25 Woman's name with similar meaning to "Linda"
- 28 Presumed contract winner
- 29 Its delta is called the Camargue
- 30 No longer trashed
- 33 "___ son las mañanitas ..." (Mexican birthday song opener)
- 34 Letters on N.Y.C. buses
- 35 "He's just ___ of clothes" (line from "The Time Traveler's Wife")
- 36 Ambitious commitment for a pop idol
- 38 They're suspended on cheat days

- 39 These may save vacationers plenty of baggage weight
- 40 Starts an argument with, say
- 41 Obsession, e.g.
- 43 Going places in the House of Commons?
- 44 Gather
- 45 Overwhelm
- 47 Lone Star State coll. with "The Best Dressed Band in the Land"
- 50 Brings home in the end
- 51 It can be unleashed in a rooting section
- 53 Poet James who is the source of the text for the soprano showpiece "Knoxville: Summer of 1915"
- 54 One whose libido is activated only in the context of a romantic bond
- 55 Makeup of many British Invasion groups
- 56 When Hispanic Heritage Mo. begins
- 57 Father of filmdom's Vincent Corleone

DOWN

- 1 Recognized minority language in Cameroon
- 2 Fill up your pad, say
- 3 Rank below marquess
- 4 Urgent radio msg. about a flight?



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- 5 Twitter account where Michaela Okland scores screenshots of cringey male behavior on social media
- 6 Pickle
- 7 Espresso-and-dessert counter at a pizza parlor, maybe
- 8 Sette meno quattro
- 9 Sandwiches that may have Amish origins
- 10 Some pre-retirement rituals
- 11 AMC Stubs ___ (cinophile's loyalty program)
- 12 Taqueria offerings?
- 14 Major costumer for 2013's "The Great Gatsby"
- 15 Milieu for some stained glass windows
- 21 Mixes often recommended to those with allergies
- 22 Big Bads who block completion of a game's story line
- 24 First cloned mammal
- 25 Command "concocted" for creating packages on macOS
- 26 Super
- 27 Discrete, maybe
- 28 Plant whose roots are fried into chips
- 30 Like most elementary school buildings
- 31 Chain that sells blenders
- 32 "Ramona the ___" (Beverly Cleary novel)
- 37 Regency Era high society
- 40 Pranksters
- 41 Artificial sound?
- 42 Alphabet horseshoe
- 43 Production style of "bedroom" musicians, informally
- 46 Something removed by a sifter
- 47 Exclude
- 48 Grouse
- 49 Reprehensible
- 51 Sports events with "excessive celebration," in brief
- 52 Prefix with -dontics